

Amnesty HRDAO Pilot: Jan – March 2026.

Participant Feedback Summary (Pilot Cohort ~40 Users)

Feedback was collected from approximately 40 participants across Aotearoa New Zealand, Australia, EU and Asia-based participants. The cohort included Amnesty staff, youth advocates, activist contacts and supporters engaging directly with the MVP DAO application. The feedback reflects hands-on interaction with the platform and provides insight into usability, governance potential, and future design considerations.

1. Usability and User Experience

Across all regions, participants consistently described the platform as **intuitive, accessible, and easy to navigate**, particularly in mobile environments. The user journey from onboarding through to participation was generally understood without significant friction.

Participants highlighted:

- Clear navigation and layout
- Strong alignment with Amnesty branding
- Engaging token balance and feedback loops
- Smooth interaction across core features

The platform's mobile-first design was particularly well received, suggesting strong alignment with contemporary user expectations.

“Really easy to use, clear, intuitive, and functional... especially on mobile, it's easy to navigate and understand how points are accumulated.”

“Overall easy to use and understand... it very much feels like an Amnesty product in terms of design.”

However, some usability refinements were identified:

- occasional pilot-stage bugs
- ambiguity around token naming (“HR tokens”)
- less clarity around token *spending* versus earning

“Did find how you spend the tokens slightly less clear than how you earn them.”

Overall, usability is **not a limiting factor**, and the MVP successfully demonstrates a functional and accessible interface.

2. Perceived Governance Value

Participants broadly agreed that the DAO model has **strong potential to enhance participation and influence** within Amnesty's governance and campaign decision-making processes.

Key themes included:

- Democratising input across large supporter bases
- Increasing transparency in decision-making
- Enabling distributed participation at scale

“I think this could significantly increase participation and influence... the tool has the potential to powerfully democratise the perspectives of thousands of users.”

At the same time, participants were clear that this value is **conditional**, not automatic. Its effectiveness depends on:

- scale of participation
- clarity of governance mechanisms
- visible impact of decisions

“Agreed it depends on participation, volume of interest.”

This reflects a mature understanding from participants: the model is promising, but requires careful implementation to realise its full potential.

3. Willingness to Participate

A strong majority of participants indicated they would **use a refined version of the platform**, suggesting meaningful demand for participatory governance tools.

Conditions for adoption were consistent across regions:

- clear explanation of DAO concepts
- transparent reward and participation mechanisms
- evidence that participation leads to real outcomes

“I would... the idea of being able to participate in online governance for an organisation I care about is really exciting.”

“Yes, but with a few clarifications... explaining how the DAO works is critical.”

This indicates that **interest is high**, but contingent on trust, clarity, and perceived legitimacy.

4. Key Strengths Identified

Several strengths were consistently identified across the cohort.

First, the **gamification model** was seen as highly effective in driving engagement and motivation.

“The balance dashboard... makes tracking live points feel rewarding, encouraging ongoing interaction.”

“The gamification aspect is promising and has a lot of potential.”

Second, the platform successfully connects **action to reward**, making participation tangible.

Third, participants recognised strong alignment with Amnesty’s mission and values.

“The idea of rewarding supporters and creating a more interactive environment is exciting.”

Overall, the system was described as:

- engaging
- motivating
- conceptually powerful

These strengths validate the core design direction of the MVP.

5. Core Challenges and Design Risks

Participants provided thoughtful and substantive critique, particularly around governance and fairness. These insights are critical for the next phase.

a. Conceptual Clarity

DAO concepts remain unfamiliar to many users and require simplification.

“Explaining how the DAO works... is critical, as this is a difficult concept to understand.”

b. Fairness and Accessibility

Concerns were raised about unequal access to participation opportunities.

“Ensuring this is fair... events and protests may not be accessible to everyone.”

c. Concentration of Influence

Participants identified risks of token accumulation leading to disproportionate influence.

“A small number of users gaining a large number of DAO points... could have an outsized influence.”

d. Governance Integrity

There is a perceived risk of coordinated actors influencing outcomes in ways misaligned with Amnesty values.

“What would happen if a group used the DAO to push for an agenda that is antithetical to Amnesty’s values?”

e. Representation and Mission Alignment

Participants questioned how decentralised governance interacts with Amnesty’s core priorities.

“How do we ensure this tool can uphold the views of people with lived experience?”

These concerns reflect a sophisticated level of engagement and reinforce that **governance design, not technology, is the primary challenge moving forward.**

6. Product and UX Improvements

Participants identified several practical improvements to enhance usability and adoption:

- clearer explanation of token use and impact
- visual dashboards showing how tokens drive outcomes
- improved navigation design (particularly mobile ergonomics)
- potential for web-based access alongside app
- more transparency around reward weighting

“Would be good to include an ‘insights’ tab... to see how tokens are used to drive impact.”

“A web-based version might improve accessibility and overcome the app download barrier.”

“Actions, Campaigns and Chat may be better as a bottom banner to match mobile grip.”

These are **incremental improvements**, not structural issues, indicating a solid underlying product foundation.

Mobile Experience and Interaction Design

While the mobile-first approach was broadly successful in delivering an intuitive and accessible user experience, several participants noted that the application could evolve toward a more dynamic and engaging interface.

There is a clear opportunity to introduce richer interaction patterns, including more responsive animations, visual feedback, and interactive flows that reinforce user actions and governance participation. At the same time, participants implicitly recognised the constraints of mobile environments, where overly complex or visually dense interactions may reduce clarity and usability.

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“A web-based version might improve accessibility and overcome the app download barrier.”

This highlights a key design consideration for future development: balancing a **mobile-first, accessible interface** with a more **expressive and dynamic user experience**, potentially through progressive enhancement across mobile and desktop environments.

Future iterations may explore lightweight animation frameworks and responsive interaction layers, while maintaining clarity, performance, and accessibility across devices.

Closing Insight

Taken together, the feedback demonstrates a high-functioning MVP that successfully translates complex governance concepts into an accessible user experience. Participants consistently reported strong usability and engagement, alongside a clear appetite for more participatory, transparent forms of decision-making within Amnesty. At the same time, the feedback reflects a thoughtful and critical engagement with the model, particularly around fairness, governance integrity, and representation.

Importantly, participants are not only validating the current system, but pointing toward its next evolution. There is a clear expectation that the platform can become more dynamic and expressive, while retaining the clarity and accessibility of its mobile-first design. This highlights a central design challenge moving forward: balancing simplicity with richer interaction, and accessibility with deeper engagement.

In short, the MVP works, and there is genuine demand for what it enables. Its success will now depend on how effectively governance mechanisms are refined, how clearly the model is communicated, and how the platform evolves to support participation at scale without compromising trust, inclusivity, or usability.